

NEXOVA TECHNOLOGIES PVT. LTD.

Employee Handbook

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Version 1.0 | Human Resources Department

Islamabad, Pakistan | Dubai, UAE | London, UK

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1. Welcome Message from the CEO

Welcome to Nexova Technologies Pvt. Ltd. On behalf of our Board of Directors, leadership team, and every one of our approximately 340 colleagues across Islamabad, Dubai, and London, I am delighted to welcome you to our family. Since our founding in 2018, we have grown from a small, passionate team of problem-solvers into a recognized leader in B2B SaaS solutions for HR and Workforce Management. That growth has always been powered by one thing: the talent, dedication, and integrity of our people. You are now part of that story, and we could not be more excited to have you with us.

This handbook is your guide to how we work, what we stand for, and what you can expect from us — and what we expect from you. It reflects our commitment to building a workplace that is transparent, equitable, and inspiring. We encourage you to read every section carefully, ask questions freely, and hold us accountable to the standards described here. Our door is always open. Here is to building something great together.

Warm regards,

Zain ul Abideen

Chief Executive Officer, Nexova Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

2. Company Overview

2.1 Mission, Vision & Values

Mission: To empower organizations across emerging and established markets with intelligent, human-centered workforce management software that simplifies complexity and unlocks people potential.

Vision: To become the most trusted HR SaaS platform across South Asia, the Middle East, and Europe by 2030.

Our Four Core Values

Integrity First	We do what we say and say what we do. Every commitment — to clients, to colleagues, to partners — is a promise we intend to keep. Transparency is not optional; it is foundational.
People at the Center	Our software exists to serve people, and so does our culture. We invest in our employees' growth, well-being, and sense of belonging because we know that thriving teams build thriving products.
Relentless Innovation	We challenge assumptions, embrace new technologies, and continuously refine our products. Comfort with change is not a trait we admire — it is a trait we hire for.
Accountable Excellence	We take ownership of our work and our mistakes. High standards are not aspirational here; they are the baseline from which we improve every single day.

2.2 Company History & Milestones

Nexova Technologies was founded in 2018 by a group of enterprise software veterans who saw a critical gap in workforce management tooling for high-growth markets. Beginning with a core team of 12 in Islamabad, the company secured its first enterprise client within six months of launch.

- 2018 — Founded in Islamabad, Pakistan; first product release (NexoHR Core)
- 2019 — Secured Series A funding of USD 4.2 million; grew to 60 employees

- 2020 — Launched Dubai office; expanded product suite to include payroll and attendance modules
- 2021 — Reached 150 enterprise clients across Pakistan, UAE, and Saudi Arabia
- 2022 — Opened London office; launched NexoAnalytics workforce intelligence module
- 2023 — Surpassed 300 employees; recognized among top 50 SaaS companies in South Asia
- 2024 — Launched API marketplace; expanded to 340 employees across three offices

2.3 Organizational Structure

Nexova operates a flat-to-mid leadership structure. The Chief Executive Officer reports to the Board of Directors. Directly reporting to the CEO are six functional heads: Chief Technology Officer (CTO), Chief Product Officer (CPO), Chief Financial Officer (CFO), Chief Revenue Officer (CRO), VP of Human Resources, and VP of Operations. Each functional head oversees department leads, who manage individual contributor teams across the three offices.

3. Employment Policies

3.1 Employment Classifications

Full-Time

Employees working a standard 40-hour week with full access to all benefits, leave entitlements, and performance review cycles.

Part-Time

Employees working fewer than 30 hours per week on a regular schedule. Benefits are provided on a pro-rated basis as outlined in the Benefits Policy.

Contract / Freelance

Individuals engaged under a fixed-term or project-based agreement. Contract workers are not entitled to standard employment benefits and are governed by their individual contracts.

Probationary

All new full-time and part-time hires are placed in Probationary status for the first three (3) months of employment. During this period, either party may end the relationship with seven (7) days' notice.

3.2 Probation Period

All new hires serve a mandatory 3-month probationary period beginning on their first day of employment. At the end of the second month, HR will initiate a Mid-Probation Check-In between the employee and their direct manager. At the 90-day mark, a formal Probation Review is conducted. The review results in one of three outcomes: (a) confirmation of employment, (b) extension of probation by up to 30 additional days with documented performance targets, or (c) termination of employment. Employees confirmed at the end of probation receive written confirmation and transition to full employment status.

3.3 Working Hours

Core working hours are 9:00 AM to 6:00 PM Pakistan Standard Time (PKT), Monday through Friday, inclusive of a one-hour lunch break. Employees in Dubai and London are expected to observe the same core hours in their respective time zones, with a minimum two-hour overlap with PKT maintained for cross-office collaboration. Nexova recognizes that flexibility improves productivity; department heads may approve flexible start times between 8:00 AM and 10:00 AM provided the full working day is completed. Overtime beyond 45 hours per week requires prior manager approval and is compensated in accordance with the applicable labour law of the employee's jurisdiction.

3.4 Remote & Hybrid Work

Remote work eligibility begins after 6 continuous months of confirmed employment (i.e., post-probation), subject to manager approval and a satisfactory performance record. Eligible employees may apply for permanent remote or hybrid arrangements by submitting a Remote Work Request Form to HR. The standard hybrid model requires a minimum of three (3) in-office days per week. Roles designated as "Office-Critical" (including but not limited to IT Infrastructure, Office Administration, and Client Solutions Engineers) are exempt from remote eligibility. Remote work arrangements are reviewed quarterly and may be revoked if performance or collaboration is negatively impacted.

4. Code of Conduct

4.1 Professional Behavior Standards

Every Nexova employee is expected to conduct themselves with professionalism, respect, and integrity at all times — whether in the office, on a client call, at a company event, or representing Nexova in any public capacity. This includes: communicating respectfully with all colleagues regardless of seniority, meeting commitments and deadlines reliably, maintaining confidentiality of company and client information, and arriving prepared and punctual to meetings and obligations.

4.2 Conflict of Interest Policy

Employees must avoid situations in which personal interests conflict — or appear to conflict — with the interests of Nexova Technologies. A conflict of interest may arise when an employee, or a close associate of the employee, stands to benefit personally from a company decision. All actual or potential conflicts must be disclosed in writing to the employee's manager and HR within 5 business days of becoming aware. This includes (but is not limited to): ownership stakes in competitor or client companies, secondary employment with a competitor, participation in procurement decisions involving a related party, or receipt of gifts valued above PKR 5,000 from vendors or clients. Undisclosed conflicts may result in disciplinary action up to and including termination.

4.3 Social Media Policy

Nexova encourages employees to engage positively on social media and to take pride in their association with the company. However, all online activity — whether on personal or professional profiles — must comply with this policy.

Employees MAY:

- Share publicly available Nexova content, blog posts, and press releases
- Express professional pride in projects or milestones (without revealing confidential details)
- Engage in industry discussions and thought leadership on their own behalf

Employees MUST NOT:

- Disclose confidential client data, product roadmaps, financial information, or internal disputes
- Make statements that could be interpreted as official Nexova positions without written authorization from the CRO or CEO
- Post defamatory, discriminatory, or harassing content about colleagues, clients, or competitors
- Use Nexova branding or logos in personal social media without prior approval from Marketing
- Discuss active legal matters, pending deals, or regulatory filings

4.4 Dress Code

The standard dress code at all Nexova offices is Business Casual. This means neat, professional attire appropriate to a modern technology workplace — collared shirts, blouses, trousers, and clean footwear. Clothing with offensive graphics, slogans, or excessive wear is not permitted. On days involving client visits, board presentations, or formal external meetings, employees are expected to dress in Business Formal attire unless otherwise communicated by their manager. Casual Fridays (jeans, clean sneakers, casual tops) are permitted at all offices unless the employee has an external engagement that day.

4.5 Workplace Relationships Policy

Nexova respects the personal lives of its employees. Consensual romantic relationships between colleagues are not prohibited; however, relationships involving a direct reporting line are strictly governed. Any employee in a supervisory relationship with a romantic partner must disclose this to HR immediately. HR will assess whether a role reassignment is necessary to eliminate any actual or perceived conflict of interest, favoritism, or power imbalance. Failure to disclose a direct-line relationship is a violation of this policy and may result in disciplinary action.

5. Anti-Harassment & Equal Opportunity

5.1 Zero Tolerance Policy

Nexova Technologies maintains an absolute zero-tolerance policy for harassment, discrimination, and intimidation of any kind. This policy applies to all employees, contractors, interns, and visitors across all three offices and in all work-related contexts including virtual meetings, company events, and business travel. Prohibited behaviors include but are not limited to:

- Sexual harassment — unwelcome advances, requests for sexual favors, or any verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature
- Discrimination based on gender, age, religion, ethnicity, nationality, disability, marital status, or socioeconomic background
- Verbal abuse, public humiliation, or deliberate exclusion of colleagues
- Intimidation, threats, or coercive behavior by any person in a position of authority
- Creation or dissemination of offensive material through any company or personal communication channel

5.2 Reporting Procedure

Employees who experience or witness harassment or discrimination are encouraged to report it promptly through the following three-step process:

Step 1 — Direct Report:

If the employee feels safe doing so, they may address the matter directly with the offending party, making clear that the behavior is unwelcome and must stop.

Step 2 — HR Department:

If direct resolution is not possible or appropriate, the employee should file a formal written complaint with HR. HR will acknowledge receipt within 2 business days.

Step 3 — Ethics Hotline:

If the employee is uncomfortable approaching HR (for example, if HR personnel are involved), they may report via the confidential Ethics Hotline at ethics@nexovatech.com. Reports may be submitted anonymously.

5.3 Investigation Process & Timelines

Upon receipt of a formal complaint, HR will designate an Investigation Officer within 3 business days. The investigation will include separate, confidential interviews with the complainant, the respondent, and any relevant witnesses. Documentary evidence and communications may be reviewed. The investigation will be completed within 21 business days of the formal complaint. Both parties will be informed of the outcome in writing. Disciplinary action, if warranted, will be imposed within 5 business days of the investigation's conclusion.

5.4 Non-Retaliation Clause

Nexova strictly prohibits retaliation against any employee who, in good faith, reports harassment or participates in an investigation. Retaliation includes any adverse employment action — demotion, reassignment, exclusion from meetings, negative performance reviews, or termination — taken against an employee as a result of their report or participation. Any manager or employee found to have retaliated against a complainant or witness will be subject to immediate disciplinary action, up to and including termination.

6. Disciplinary Procedure

6.1 Four-Stage Disciplinary Process

Nexova follows a structured, progressive disciplinary process designed to give employees a fair opportunity to correct performance or conduct issues.

Stage 1 — Verbal Warning:

The manager discusses the issue with the employee in a private meeting. The conversation is documented internally by HR. The employee is given clear, measurable expectations for improvement within a defined timeframe (typically 30 days).

Stage 2 — Written Warning:

If the issue persists or a new violation occurs, HR issues a formal Written Warning. This document details the nature of the misconduct, previous counselling, expected corrective action, and consequences of further violations. The employee must sign acknowledgment of receipt.

Stage 3 — Final Warning:

A Final Warning is issued for continued or serious violations. It constitutes formal notice that termination will follow any further breach. A Performance Improvement Plan (PIP) may accompany the Final Warning with milestones tracked over 30–60 days.

Stage 4 — Termination:

If the employee fails to meet the requirements of the PIP, or if a further violation occurs, employment is terminated. HR and the relevant department head must jointly approve the termination decision prior to notification.

6.2 Grounds for Immediate Termination

The following violations bypass the progressive disciplinary process and constitute grounds for summary (immediate) termination:

- Theft, fraud, or deliberate misappropriation of company or client assets
- Disclosure of confidential or proprietary information to unauthorized parties
- Falsification of employment records, expense claims, timesheets, or qualifications
- Physical violence, threats of violence, or possession of weapons on company premises
- Sexual harassment or assault of any colleague, client, or visitor
- Gross insubordination — willful refusal to carry out lawful, reasonable instructions from a supervisor
- Unauthorized access to, or tampering with, company systems, databases, or client data
- Reporting to work under the influence of alcohol or illegal substances, or consuming them on company premises
- Conduct that causes material reputational harm to Nexova Technologies

6.3 Appeal Process

An employee who believes a disciplinary decision was unfair or procedurally incorrect may submit a written appeal to the VP of Human Resources within 7 calendar days of the decision. The VP of Human Resources will review the appeal, consult with relevant parties, and issue a written response within 10 business days. The decision of the VP of Human Resources is final and binding, except in cases of alleged discrimination or ethics violations, which are escalated to the CEO.

7. Resignation & Offboarding

7.1 Notice Periods

All resignations must be submitted in writing (email to the direct manager and HR is acceptable). The following notice periods apply by seniority level:

Seniority Level	Examples	Notice Period
Junior / Associate	Software Engineer I & II, Analyst, Support Agent	2 weeks
Senior / Specialist	Senior Engineer, Lead Designer, Sr. Analyst	4 weeks
Manager & Above	Engineering Manager, Director, VP, C-Suite	6 weeks

7.2 Exit Interview Process

All departing employees are invited to participate in a structured Exit Interview conducted by an HR Business Partner. The interview is voluntary but strongly encouraged. It covers the employee's overall experience, feedback on management and culture, reasons for departure, and any suggestions for improvement. Feedback is aggregated and reported to the VP of Human Resources quarterly, with identifying information removed. Exit interview responses will not influence final references or employment records.

7.3 Asset Return Checklist

Prior to or on the last working day, all departing employees must return the following company assets:

- Company laptop, charger, and any peripherals issued
- Mobile device or SIM card (if company-issued)
- Office access cards, keys, and parking passes
- Security tokens or hardware authentication devices
- Client documents, contracts, or physical files
- Company credit card or petty cash float (if applicable)

HR will issue an Asset Return Clearance Form upon confirmation that all items have been returned. IT will revoke all system access on the employee's final day, and accounts will be deactivated within 24 hours of departure.

7.4 Final Paycheck Timeline

The final paycheck, inclusive of all earned and accrued salary, encashable leave balance, and any approved expense reimbursements, will be processed within 10 business days of the employee's last working day. Any outstanding advances, equipment replacement costs, or other deductions will be applied in accordance with the signed employment agreement. Employees will receive a final payslip and tax documentation (as applicable) within 30 calendar days of departure.

Employee Acknowledgment

I acknowledge that I have received, read, and understood the Nexova Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Employee Handbook (Effective January 1, 2025). I agree to comply with all policies contained herein and understand that this handbook does not constitute a contract of employment.

Employee Full Name: _____

Employee ID: _____

Department: _____

Date: _____

Signature: _____

Nexova Technologies Pvt. Ltd. | hr@nexovatech.com | Islamabad | Dubai | London